

Calculated Fields, Parameters & LOD Expressions

Q1. What is a Calculated Field and why is it important in business dashboards?

Ans. A Calculated Field is a custom field created using formulas in Tableau to perform calculations on existing data. It helps analysts derive new metrics and business insights without modifying the original dataset.

Calculated fields are important because they enable users to create KPIs, perform advanced analysis, and support better decision-making.

Q2. Why can't parameters change visuals directly in Tableau?

Ans. Parameters cannot change visuals directly because they only store a single user-defined value and do not automatically filter or modify data. To affect visuals, parameters must be connected to calculated fields, filters, or reference lines.

Q3. When should EXCLUDE LOD be used?

Ans. EXCLUDE LOD is used when calculations need to ignore one or more dimensions present in the view. It helps calculate aggregated values at a higher level than the current visualization.

Example: Calculating average sales across all products while ignoring product-level details.

Q4. Difference between FIXED and INCLUDE LOD expressions?

Ans. FIXED LOD

Calculates values at a specified level of detail regardless of dimensions in the view

Ignore dimension added to the visualization

Not affected by non-context filters.

INCLUDE LOD

Adds additional dimensions to the current level of detail in the view.

Considers dimension present in the visualization.

Affected by filters in the view.